



Taxing robots?

San Francisco is planning to launch a new campaign called "Jobs of the Future Fund" that will tax robots. <http://digit.in/TaxingBots>



Dynasty Warriors 9 for PC

An announcement made by Koei Tecmo confirms that Dynasty Warriors 9 is coming to PC and will be available on Steam. <http://digit.in/Dynasty9>

Subscription model everything

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hopping, or commerce in general, is a large part of human civilisation. We buy things we need or

want on a regular basis. And this act of purchase has led to markets and economies rising and falling over time. Whether it be online shopping, retail stores or any other method, the fact remains that we buy stuff and we do it a lot. With online shopping, this very act has been simplified, to say the very least. Everything from vegetables to private jets are available online. And amid all of this, a new kind of purchasing habit has taken hold in many sectors – subscriptions.

WHAT ARE SUBSCRIPTIONS?

We are not talking about your subscriptions to a weekly newspaper or magazine (like Digit). Although that is where the idea originated, we are talking about subscriptions that have replaced individual product purchases. So, for instance, your Netflix subscription makes sure that you don't need to buy or rent DVDs anymore (interestingly, Netflix started off as DVD rental). Now the kind of subscriptions that we are talking about could be for anything – a fresh pack of razors being delivered to your doorstep every month? Available. A subscription to your favourite luxury cars? Why not? But one particular subscription area has attracted a lot of attention – subscription boxes.

Why have subscription models invaded everything in the last couple of years

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Broadly speaking, a subscription box service will send you a box of products for a fixed amount every month. These products could be curated from multiple manufacturers, like Birchbox, or could be from their own manufacturing line. Bottom line is - subscription boxes are insanely popular. Don't believe us? Check out the popular YouTube fashion/lifestyle blogger network that thrives on reviewing subscription boxes and their content every month.



A typical box from LetsShave, an online grooming products subscription service in India

Subscription Addiction, a website that lists as many subscription boxes as possible, based on what we could calculate from its listing of Monthly subscription boxes there are about 2,500 subscription boxes available right now! These boxes spread across categories like Books, Crafts, kids products, and more. According to Amir Elaguizy, founder of Cratejoy (a SquareSpace like service for Subscription box companies) the number is much larger at around 10,000 such services. He also states that the subscription economy has been growing at a whopping 200% since 2011. No wonder you see more of those boxes every day!

As the above statistics indicate, the subscription model is neither new nor rare. From Netflix to LinkedIn Premium, you've been paying for services and software in an online, connected world for a while now. Major software vendors like Adobe and Microsoft have moved their best-selling products onto subscription models. But why does it work?

ARE THEY POPULAR?

You bet they are (a solid reason why we are talking about it). According to My

WHY DOES IT WORK?

On the surface, there are many individual reasons for each subscription